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The Vietnam War
World War I
World War II

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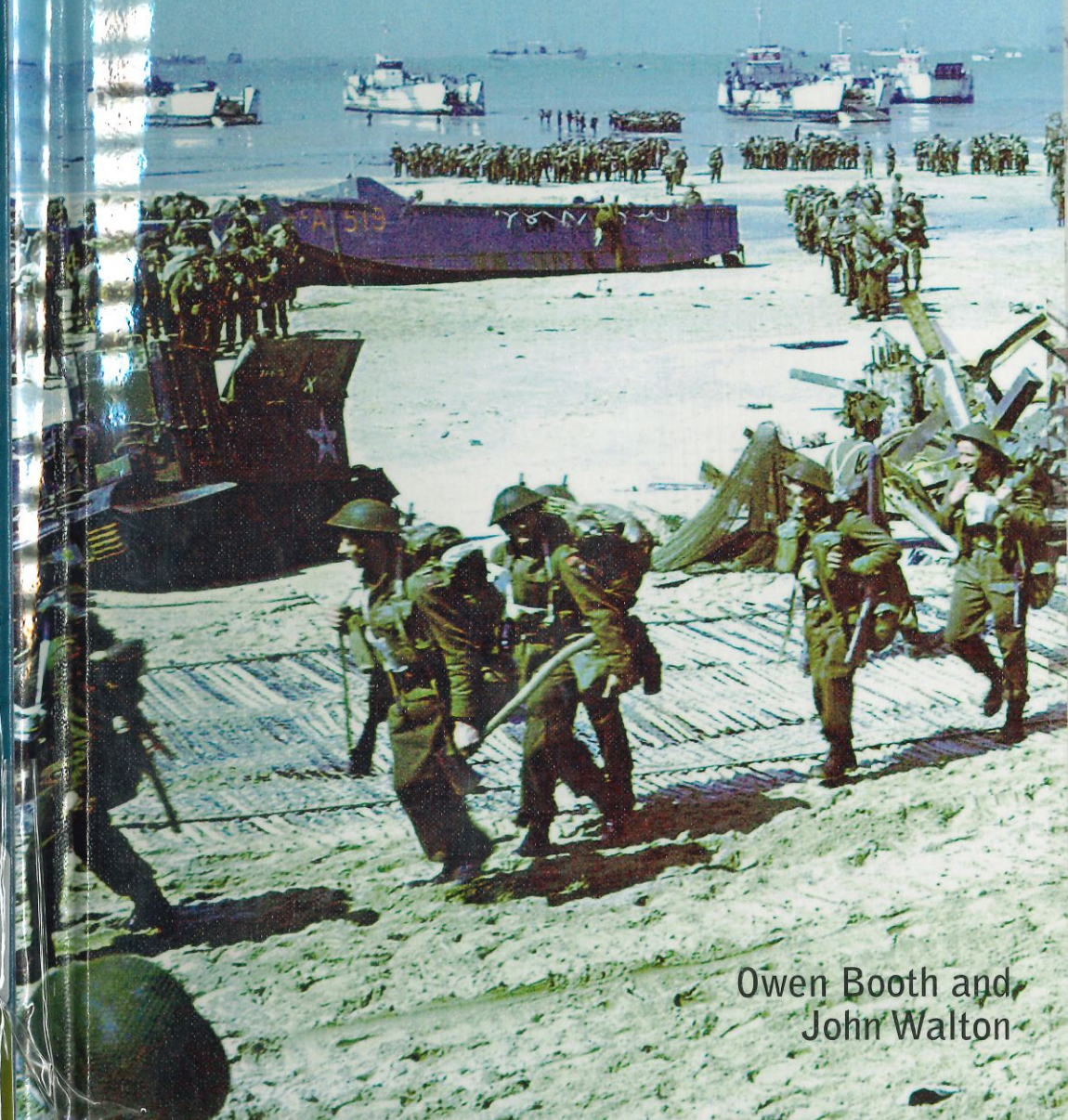


Booth and Walton

Primary
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in World
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World War II

World War II



Owen Booth and
John Walton

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THE ATOMIC BOMB

As the island-hopping proceeded, so did the work on a super weapon designed to bring about a speedy Japanese surrender. The atomic bomb was also designed to make sure that the Allies beat the Germans to the making of this most deadly of weapons. Most of the early work undertaken by the Allies on the bomb had been done in Britain, but the British lacked the resources to pursue the research to its conclusion. The project was therefore passed on to the United States soon after it joined the war in December 1941. President Roosevelt devoted the \$2 billion necessary for the project, and US, British, Canadian and other scientists began a race against time to complete the bomb before their enemies got there first.

THE PHILIPPINES

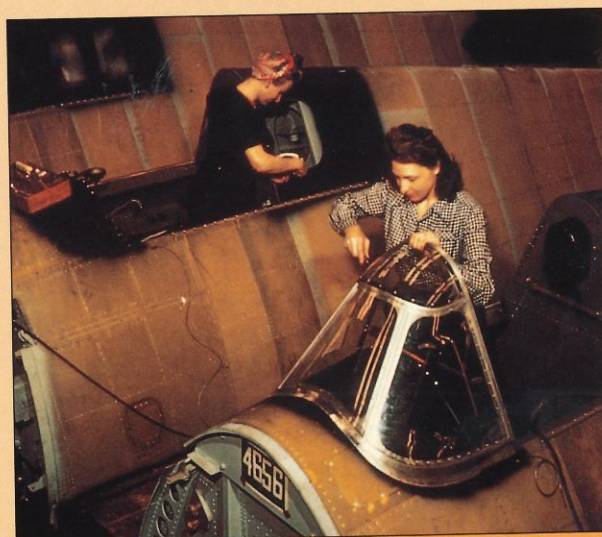
Despite, or because of, the increasingly swift Allied advance across the Pacific, Japanese resistance, already dogged, became increasingly fanatical. The Japanese High Command decided that the Philippines must be defended at all costs and, accordingly, the war-scarred remnants of the Imperial Japanese Navy were committed to the destruction of the American invasion force. The confrontation on October 24 and 25, 1944 became known as the Battle of Leyte Gulf and remains to this day the biggest single naval battle ever fought. The Japanese plan was simple. The Imperial Navy's remaining aircraft carriers would be used as bait to draw off the US ships defending the invasion force, while Japanese battleships attacked the undefended troops coming ashore.

In the event, however, the Imperial Navy suffered yet another crushing blow, and one that was to end its days as an effective fighting force. US submarines, torpedo boats and

WOMEN IN THE WAR

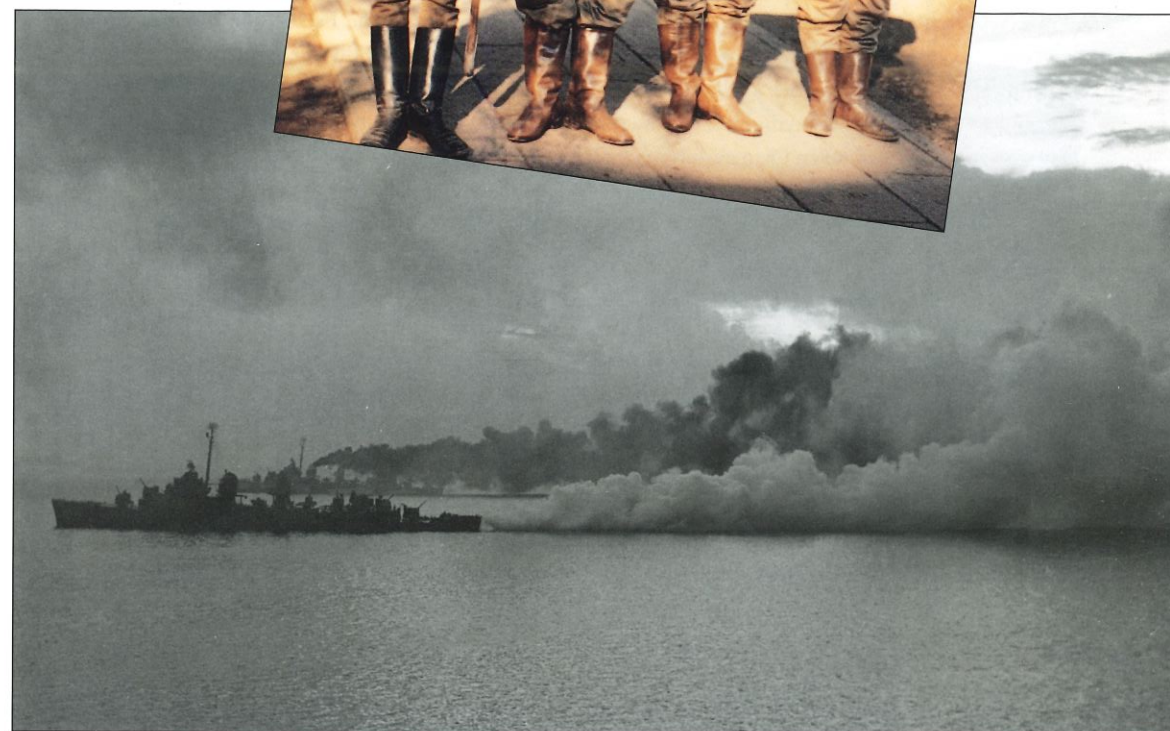
Unlike any previous conflict, World War II affected soldiers and civilians, men and women in equal measure, and American women lost no time in answering the call to work for the war effort in factories as well as the newly established female branches of the armed services. Following the example of the tough "can do" propaganda poster, "Rosie the Riveter," American women poured into the munitions factories to ensure that manufacturing levels were not adversely affected by the industry's loss of men to the armed forces.

American women, unlike their British counterparts, were not conscripted to the war effort; high wages alone proved sufficient encouragement for more than six million to enter the workforce. Yet, even though their wages often increased, women found their average earnings were still only half that of men. By 1944 American women made up just one-third of a workforce dedicated to producing not only the munitions that the United States needed to take on the armed might of Japan and Germany, but also a quarter of Britain's needs and 10 percent of the Soviet Union's.



REAL LIFE ROSIE THE RIVETERS GET TO WORK IN THE GRUMANN AIRCRAFT FACTORY.

RIGHT: JAPANESE KAMIKAZE
SUICIDE PILOTS PRESENT
THEIR EMPEROR WITH A
FINAL BOW BEFORE
CLIMBING ON BOARD THEIR
EXPLOSIVE-FILLED PLANES,
WHICH THEY HOPE
TO CRASH LAND INTO
THE US FLEET.



aircraft carriers proved more than equal to the challenge offered them by the world's two largest warships, the *Yamato* and the *Musashi*. Most of the Japanese fleet was sent to the bottom after they failed to realize that their plan was on the verge of success, and committed a tactical blunder that led to their total destruction. The United States destroyed 26 Japanese ships and damaged another 25, but their victory was not without loss. One US carrier was wiped out by a new Japanese weapon, the kamikaze pilot, a title that meant "divine wind." The kamikaze, on a one-way mission with his plane full of explosives, effectively committed suicide for his emperor. After performing sacred rituals, he left his base with the intention of crashing his aircraft into the nearest Allied target. As the war in the Pacific reached its final stage, the kamikaze pilot and others who were, likewise, prepared to kill themselves for the emperor, played an increasingly prominent role.

ABOVE: DURING THE
BATTLE OF LEYTE GULF,
DESTROYERS OF THE US
FLEET LAID SMOKE-SCREENS
TO PROTECT ALLIED SHIPS
FROM ATTACK BY
THE JAPANESE.

The invasion of Japan was not a prospect the United States contemplated with relish. The Imperial Japanese Army and Navy had, for the last four years, displayed a desperate and suicidal wish to defeat them.

With the Japanese fleet destroyed, the Americans were able to secure Leyte, and then press on north to the largest island of the Philippines group, Luzon. MacArthur fulfilled his pledge to return, and by March 3, 1945, Manila was once more in US hands. Although it was not yet clear to all those involved, the war in the Pacific had entered its final phases. By the time US troops entered Manila, the Marine Corps was well on the way to capturing Iwo Jima, a small volcanic island whose airstrips put B-29 bombers within range of Japan, and were beginning preparations for the capture of Okinawa in the Ryukus, the southernmost group of the Japanese home islands.

OKINAWA

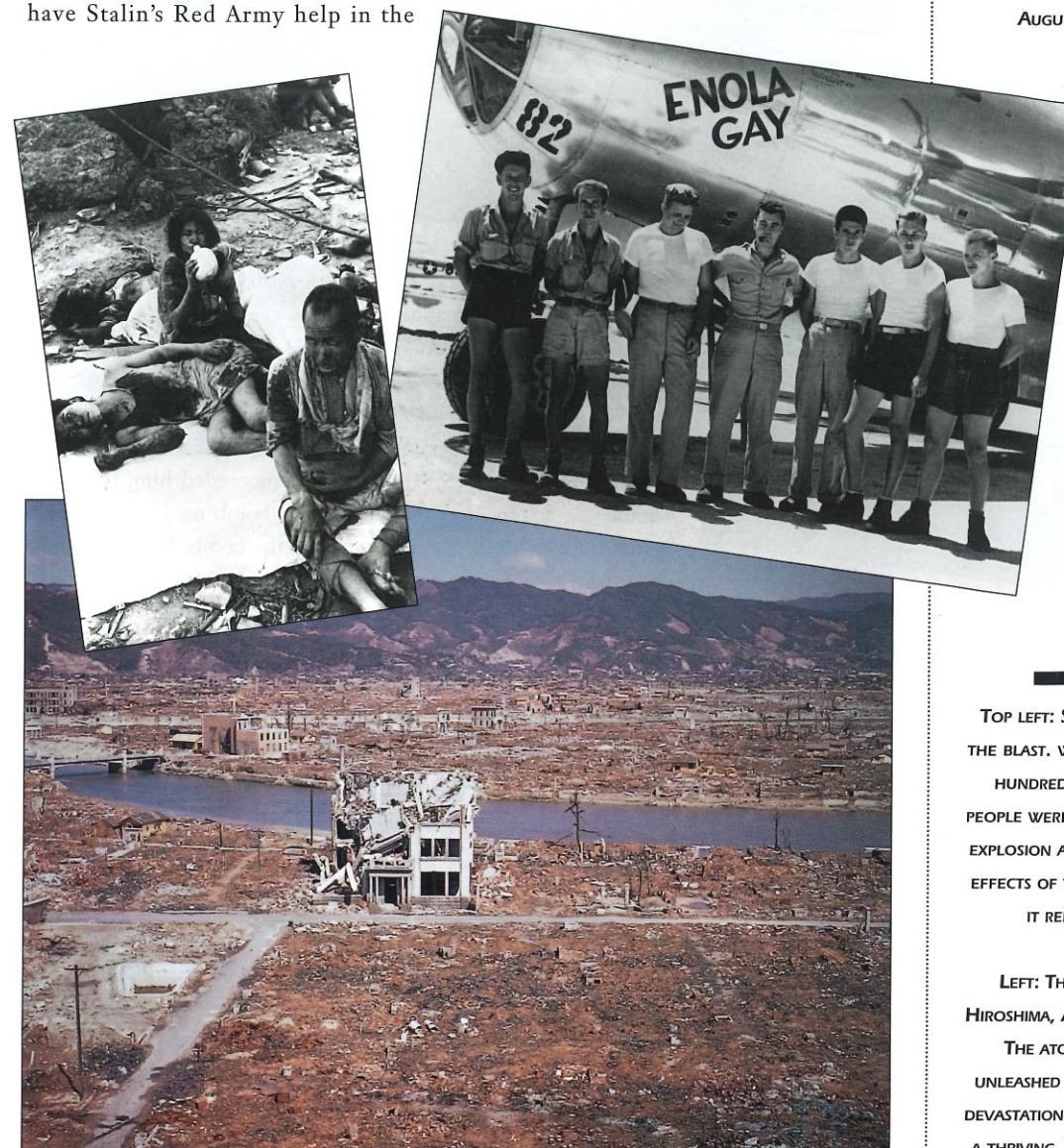
As had occurred many times before right across the Pacific, the Marines' initial landings on Okinawa met with little initial resistance. But the ferocity of the Japanese will to fight back against the massive military strength of the United States had lost none of its fury. If anything, this close to the heartland of Japan, it increased. By the time the Marines had taken Okinawa on June 22, there had been nearly 2,000 kamikaze attacks, 20 or 30 per day, causing appalling damage to the US landing fleet and the Marines themselves. Yet, for all the losses they caused, the kamikaze attacks could not change the course of the war. With the capture of Okinawa, the Allies not only had another airstrip from which to carry out air raids on Japan, they also had a base from which Japan itself could be invaded.



RIGHT: A RARE SIGHT. JAPANESE TROOPS SURRENDER ON OKINAWA. MANY JAPANESE PREFERRED SUICIDE TO CAPTURE, YET THESE NAVAL TROOPS HAVE GIVEN THEMSELVES UP UNDER THE COVER OF THE WHITE FLAG TO A MEMBER OF THE US MARINE CORPS.

DROPPING THE BOMB

The invasion of Japan was not a prospect the United States contemplated with relish. The Imperial Japanese Army and Navy had, for the last four years, displayed a desperate and suicidal wish to defeat them. They had refused to surrender time and time again, and when resistance could no longer change the final outcome, Japanese forces had displayed a desire simply to kill as many Americans as possible before they themselves died. US Army chiefs estimated that the invasion of Japan might take until 1946 or 1947 to complete and could cost upward of one million American dead. To lessen these expected casualties, the Americans were keen to have Stalin's Red Army help in the



BELOW: THE CREW OF THE ENOLA GAY, THE B-29 THAT DROPPED THE ATOMIC BOMB OVER HIROSHIMA, POSE FOR A SNAPSHOT SHORTLY BEFORE TAKEOFF, AUGUST 1945.

TOP LEFT: SURVIVORS OF THE BLAST. WELL OVER ONE HUNDRED THOUSAND PEOPLE WERE KILLED BY THE EXPLOSION AND THE AFTER-EFFECTS OF THE RADIATION IT RELEASED.

LEFT: THE RUINS OF HIROSHIMA, AUGUST 1945. THE ATOMIC BOMB UNLEASHED UNBELIEVABLE DEVASTATION ON WHAT WAS A THRIVING JAPANESE CITY.

Harry S. Truman (had to) decide whether or not to drop the new atomic bomb on Japan. Truman believed he had little choice but to use the bomb.



invasion. The Soviet dictator, welcoming the chance to extend his influence into Manchuria and Japan itself, agreed, though he did not declare war on Japan until August 8, 1945.

Air strikes were the inevitable prelude to the invasion, but while they were in progress, an extremely difficult choice had to be made. President Roosevelt had died suddenly on April 12, and it fell to his vice president, Harry S. Truman, who succeeded him, to decide whether or not to drop the new atomic bomb on Japan. Truman believed he had little choice but to use the bomb. No matter how dreadful it was, it could shorten the war and save American lives.

On August 6, 1945, the first atomic bomb was dropped on Hiroshima. This new device unleashed an explosive force equivalent to 20,000 tons (18,143.7 t) of high explosive, killing some 78,000 people and injuring another 78,000. Hiroshima itself was virtually vaporized, blasted out of existence by the awesome power harnessed inside a single bomb. On August 9, after Hiroshima failed to prompt a Japanese surrender, a second atomic bomb was dropped on Nagasaki. This time, 26,000 died and over 40,000 were injured. The dead, however, were the lucky ones, for the wounded suffered in ways never seen before as radiation burned and slowly poisoned them. Decades later, the victims of Hiroshima and Nagasaki were still dying. The Americans had ended a war with the most fearsome weapon ever devised and one that would cast its malignant shadow over generations yet unborn.

SURRENDER

Six days later, on August 14, the Japanese Emperor, Hirohito, who was regarded as divine by his subjects, made his first-ever radio broadcast. Hirohito explained to his people, who were hearing his voice for the first time, that "the war has developed, not necessarily to our advantage." It was as close as the Emperor could get to admitting defeat.

ABOVE: THE OFFICERS AND MEN OF THE USS MISSOURI GATHER TO WATCH THE JAPANESE DELEGATION ARRIVES TO SIGN THE OFFICIAL DOCUMENT OF SURRENDER, TOKYO BAY, 1945.

ABOVE RIGHT: THE JAPANESE DELEGATION ARRIVES.

On August 28, US troops began the occupation of Japan, and on September 2, General MacArthur accepted the official capitulation on board USS Missouri, moored off Tokyo Bay. With the end of the fighting in the Pacific, World War II reached its final conclusion, almost six years to the day after it had begun.



LEFT: IN HAWAII, WHERE IT ALL STARTED FOR THE UNITED STATES, EARLY-RISING WORKERS AND SERVICE MEN CELEBRATE THE JAPANESE SURRENDER AND THE ALLIED VICTORY IN THE PACIFIC, REPRESENTING THE CLOSING OF WORLD WAR II'S FINAL CHAPTER.

FIRESTORMS OVER JAPAN

The prelude to the Allied invasion of Japan was an intensive bombing campaign designed to cripple Japan's war economy, communications, resources and will to fight. Unfortunately, such widespread strategic bombing inevitably led to horrific numbers of civilian casualties.



A US AIR FORCE SUPERFORTRESS RAINS FIRE ON JAPAN.

US raids over Japan proper began toward the end of 1944. The principal aircraft used was the B-29 "Superfortress." As the offensive progressed, debate grew within the US Army Air Force about the most effective tactics. Eventually, after some heart-searching, precision bombing was abandoned in favor of the carpet bombing of Japan's cities, which often contained houses built of paper and wood as a defense against earthquakes. Consequently, the incendiaries delivered in low-level night-time attacks, using up to 500 bombers at a time, led to firestorms right across Japan. The authorities were helpless in the face of this gargantuan assault. Attempts by civilians to put out the flames were pathetic. All they had was the regulation sandbag and bucket of water to contend with a phenomenal 10 million incendiary bombs, many containing napalm, which rained down from the skies. Many Japanese families who attempted to escape the flames by hiding in water tanks were later found dead after being boiled alive. By July 1945, nearly one million Japanese civilians had been killed as firestorms ate their way through Tokyo, Osaka, Kobe, Kawasaki and Yokohama.